

Keeping Units (SKU) of its own, hosted stores (much like a marketplace) and aggregated prices as well. To be fair, by and large hard comparisons were made within comparable categories; marketplaces to either marketplaces or aggregators, speciality shops to other speciality shops etc.

However, another way of looking at the comparison is that as a consumer, you don't care what shop you buy your products from as long as you get the best

availability. eBay.in got the highest score for an appealing mix of price and availability, followed by shopping.indiatimes.com and naaptol.com. Indiaplaza.in also fared pretty well as there was a ₹2,000 limited period discount on the Galaxy SII at the time of accumulating prices. The site often has such attractive offers, so while buying mobiles it would be a good idea to search for your desired model at this web site. flipkart.com offers decent pricing, but scored

lower due to non-availability of two popular Nokia phones from our sample list. Among web sites that keep their own stock, infibeam.com scored the highest and will be a worthy destination to check out before making a purchase decision online.

Tablets

For tablets, again eBay.in came out on top with a high margin compared

to other marketplaces while shopmania.in aggregated the best prices. Our scores, however, ascertained that the best destination for buying tablets is adexmart.in when it comes to multi-category web sites.

Notebook / Netbook

The notebook / netbook segment was a tough one to tackle because of the various permutations and combinations possible in the configurations. Not many of the sites offered a large range or variants in certain models. The results of this category comparison can largely be considered inconclusive. Still amongst

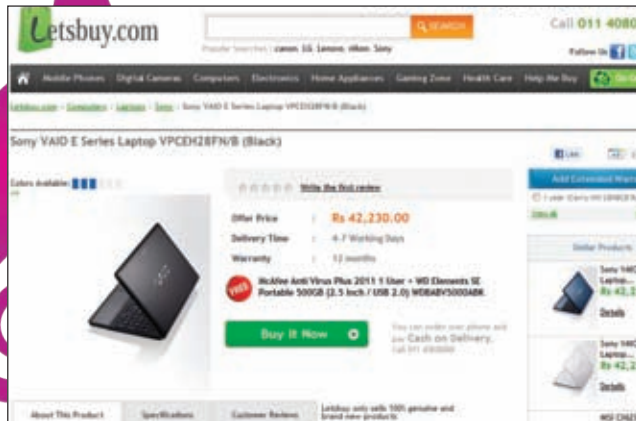
what we looked for, Rediff offered reasonably decent prices and breadth. As consumers, the best bet would be to decide on a particular series from a manufacturer, look for particular specs and settle for the nearest configuration.

Cameras

For cameras, we selected popular entry-level dSLRs as well as Point-and-Shoots, Micro Four Thirds as well as difficult-to-procure models such as the Panasonic Lumix TZ7. eBay.in can get you the cheapest rates while BigAdda.com and Letsbuy seem to be the next best places to go to while shopping for cameras. Rediff on the other hand, gives you some of the not-so-easily available cameras, at least, according to the sample that we chose. So if you're interested in buying a camera this Diwali, it would be worth your while to head over to this shopping portal to browse around. Interestingly, Letsbuy.com has a whole bunch of freebies thrown in with its camera listings. For instance, with its Canon 1100D you get a Silicon Power 16GB Class-10 SD Card, a Vanguard Tripod Aluminum MAK 233 and a carry case; while the Canon SX 30IS listing bundles a photo frame. These freebies are worth checking out if you intend on buying them separately anyway.

Computer components and peripherals

Initially, we fixed on a mid-range rig configuration and began searching for components on aggregators and speciality component sites. At the end of the exercise we found that except for marketplaces and aggregators, there aren't any other web sites where you can get all the components



Letsbuy.com has some interesting offers

price. So, whether eBay or Naaptol lets you find a particular graphics card or a speciality store stocks it themselves, may not be very relevant to the end user. While noting prices we went up to the last possible point in the checkout cycle before payment to get a price inclusive of shipping and VAT and any other charges.

So after much research, we present to you in these pages, some of the best places to buy tech products online.

Mobiles

As expected, the aggregators and marketplaces scored highest thanks to ease of

Categories	Ebay.in	Indiatimes Shopping	Rediff Shopping	Naaptol	Shopmania	Adexmart	AnythingInIT	BitFang	Flipkart	Homeshop18	Indiaplaza.in	Infibeam	LetsBuy	Techshop.in	TheITwares.com	Tradeus.in
Mobile Phones	96.76	93.47	90.38	93.28	92.49	82.75	39.86	75.03	82.02	87.36	93.54	93.46	91.67	78.31	39.86	73.81
Tablets	99.12	86.42	76.53	78.4	91.3	77.48	63.51	62.99	67.79	52.84	63.61	41.45	68.27	52.51	41.45	79.14
Notebook/Netbook	69.2	61.27	59.84	54.31	54.21	45.35	70.59	60.74	53.84	45.35	45.35	63.88	63.71	45.35	45.35	54.66
Misc	82.94	57.85	56.56	63.65	71.91	41.25	40.58	41.31	54.78	61.8	47.01	64.46	70.53	38.7	44.36	53.77
Cameras	67.73	62.96	63.18	64.35	65.74	49.83	36.62	43.73	62.42	54.67	62.18	65.4	62.42	58.67	36.62	62.9
Mid-Range Computer Components	86.48	42.25	46.77	60.3	85.96	38.3	55.43	64.51	44.08	38.09	40.38	37.99	34.42	62.33	64.15	34.42
High-end Computer Components	87.94	48.27	54.04	56.86	91.82	43	63.49	77.34	43	43	43	43	61.99	69.35	82.23	43

Note: The scores are based on prices and availability of products during the time data was collected. They are indicative only for the selection of products picked out. For a different set of products, at another point in time the scores will vary. For the full scoresheet, visit this Google Docs link: http://bit.ly/shop_logs